

# 1 JANUARY 2024 - 31 DECEMBER 2025

# ACTIVITY REPORT

Alumni Association
College of Europe
Collège d'Europe
Association des Anciens Étudiants

Brugge

Natolin

# TABLE OF CONTENT


1. WORD OF THE PRESIDENT.....3

2. FLAGSHIP PROJECTS.....4

3. POLICY/SOCIALEVENTS .....10

4. ALUMNI REGIONAL GROUPS AND ACTIVITIES.....17

5. HIVEBRITE PLATFORM.....22

6. MEMBERSHIP.....23

7. PARTNERSHIPS.....24

8. SOCIAL MEDIA ENGAGEMENT.....25

## 1. WORD OF THE PRESIDENT

**Dear Fellow Alumni,**

Happy New Year. I wish you a wonderful, healthy, and successful 2026 ahead!

Thank you for the positive feedback and the increasing engagement across our community, which I hope reflect the progress made over the past two years. At the same time, I am convinced that our Association has even greater potential and that, together, we can do more - and do it better.

Today, nearly **3,000 alumni** actively participate in our events and activities, and more than **9, 000 alumni** are connected through the Hivebrite platform. Our **Anniversary Dinners** bring together generations of alumni in a spirit of continuity and belonging, while initiatives such as the **EPSO training and Mentorship Programme** support young professionals at critical stages of their careers. Through the **Alumni Lunch Series**, we have also fostered in-depth exchanges with EU leaders, offering alumni the opportunity to engage directly with top officials and experts on Europe's future. Our **regional groups** are becoming more engaged, helping to connect alumni across the globe.

Looking ahead, my priority is to launch the process of **institutionalising the Alumni Association** within the College of Europe. This reflection is driven by a simple conviction: our Association can achieve greater impact, continuity, and ambition if its work is supported by a more sustainable structure. **As a volunteer-led organisation** supported by a single administrative officer, our resources are necessarily limited.

I would like to extend my sincere gratitude to the Administrative Officer and the Board of the Alumni Association for their dedication and commitment. Above all, I thank you - **our Alumni** - whose ideas, participation, and willingness to give back are the true strength of this community.

Finally, I would like to express my gratitude to the **College of Europe** for its continued trust, support, and close cooperation. Together, we strive to ensure that *L'Esprit du Collège* remains alive - contributing, in our own way, to the Europe of today and tomorrow!

With my warmest regards,

**Dr. Teona Lavrelashvili**
**President, College of Europe Alumni Association**

## 2. FLAGSHIPS PROJECTS

### *Mentorship Programme*

The Alumni Mentorship Programme, now in its **seventh edition**, remains one of the Association's flagship initiatives. It connects students and young graduates with senior alumni, offering guidance on career development while fostering long-term professional relationships and a culture of mutual support within the College network.



#### 2025 Edition

- Announced in **July 2025**, with the programme starting soon
- H**igh interest** shown
- The programme has **officially started beginning of December 2025**
- Currently planning webinar for participants with coaches/HR consultants (date tbc)

#### 2024 Edition

MENTORSHIP PROGRAMME
A COLLEGE OF EUROPE ALUMNI ASSOCIATION INITIATIVE

- Officially launched in **September 2024**
- **Positive feedback** from participants highlighted:
- Support in **career decision-making**
- Opportunities to **expand professional networks**
- Increased **confidence** in taking next steps

## *Anniversary Dinners*

**2025 Edition**



| Date | Promotions (Anniversary) | Participants |
|---|---|---|
| **7 June** | *Robert Schuman (60th), William II of Orange (55th), Aristide Briand (50th), Salvador de Madariaga (45th)* | 79 |
| **14 June** | *Falcone and Borsellino (10th), Hannah Arendt (5th)* | 148 |
| **13 September** | *Charles Darwin (15th), Montesquieu (20th)* | 201 |
| **20 September** | *Madame de Staël (40th), Denis de Rougemont (35th)* | 88 |
| **4 October** | *Ramon Llull (30th), Wilhelm & Alexander von Humboldt (25th)* | 204 |

***In total, 720 Alumni participated to the Anniverdsary Dinners in 2025.*** ✅

**2024 Edition**



| Date | Promotions (Anniversary) | Participants |
|---|---|---|
| **1 June** | *Christopher Dawson (35th), Jean Rey (40th), Paul-Henri Spaak (45th), Giuseppe Mazzini (50th), Konrad Adenauer (55th), Thomas Paine (60th), Fridtjof Nansen (65th)* | 131 |
| **15 June** | *John Locke (20th), Leonardo da Vinci (25th), Stefan Zweig (30th)* | 291 |
| **14 September** | *Voltaire (10th), Marcus Aurelius (15th)* | 140 |
| **21 September** | *Manuel Marin (5th)* | 69 |

***In total, 631 alumni participated in the Anniversary Dinners in 2024.*** ✅

## *Epso Initiative*

In 2025, the Alumni Association launched a new **EPSO AD5 training course** to support alumni preparing for the upcoming competition. The initiative aims to **expand professional development opportunities** within the alumni community.

**Key Highlights**

- **Start of First Round:** September 2025
- **Start of Second Round:** December 2025
- **Structure:** Participants divided into **groups** for a more **personalised and effective learning experience**
- **Feedback:** Initial sessions have received **very positive responses** from participants
- **Membership Impact:** Linking participation to **paid membership** has already proved strategic, leading to an **increase in membership requests**

## *Alumni Lunch Series*



The Alumni Lunch Series has established itself as one of our most successful initiatives. Established in 2025, these informal, off-the-record exchanges between senior alumni and distinguished guests from the EU institutional sphere provide a unique forum for in-depth dialogue on key developments and institutional perspectives, held under the Chatham House Rule. The series has also become a highly valued networking and learning platform, fostering meaningful connections and knowledge exchange across generations of alumni.

Below is a table summarising the guests we have welcomed so far, as well as those planned for the coming months:

| ***Keynote Speaker*** | **Date** |
|---|---|
| **Klaus Welle**, *Chair of Marten Centre & Special Advisor to the Commissioner for Defence and Space* | 11 March 2025 |
| **Valentina Superti**, *Director General at DG ENEST* | 23 April 2025 |
| **Skander Nasra**, *Senior Advisor in the Cabinet of the Commissioner for Enlargement* | 17 June 2025 |
| **Vincent Laporte**, *Head of Sector for the European Peace Facility, Externa, Action Service* | 30 June 2025 |
| **Delphine Colard**, *Spokesperson of the European Parliament* | 14 July 2025 |
| **Franck Debié**, *Director of the Library & Knowledge Services at EPRS* | 4 September 2025 |
| **Isabelle Le Galo Florès**, *Secretary General at Economic and Social Committee* | 19 September 2025 |
| **Deša Srsen**, *Deputy Head of Cabinet of Commissioner for the Mediterranean* | 6 October 2025 |





| *Keynote Speaker* | **Date** |
|---|---|
| **Stefano Sannino**, *Director-General at DG MENA* | 6 November 2025 |
| **Maciej Popowski,** *Director General at DG ECHO* | 8 December 2025 |
| **Michael Hager,** *Head of Cabinet to the Commissioner for Economy and Productivity* | 10 December 2025 |




















## 3. POLICY / SOCIAL EVENTS

- **College of Europe Alumni Association Networking Drinks (26 February 2025)**: The Alumni Association hosted an informal networking evening to bring together alumni from diverse promotions and professional backgrounds. The event provided a relaxed setting for exchanging ideas, strengthening professional ties, and fostering connections across the College of Europe community.












- **Welcome Back Gathering (18 September 2025):** Held at The Nine with keynote speaker Karolina Kottova, Deputy Head of Cabinet to the Commissioner for Enlargement. The event was **well received**, with **70 participants** and strong alumni engagement.









- **The Future of Work: Balancing Europe's Competitiveness and Social Priorities (27 October 2025)**: Co-organised by the Alumni Association and the UK Mission to the EU, this event gathered professionals and experts to discuss shaping the future workplace in the UK and EU. The discussion focused on balancing economic competitiveness with social fairness amid technological change and encouraged networking among alumni.







- **Europe's Next Chapter: How Will Enlargement Strengthen the Union? (2 December 2025):** Organised by the College of Europe Alumni Association, this policy event gathered alumni and guests to discuss the future of EU enlargement. With contributions from Karolina Kottova and Selma Haenicke, and moderated by Teona Lavrelashvili, the discussion focused on recent developments in EU enlargement policy, its geopolitical implications, and the role of the EU institutions, while encouraging exchange among alumni.







## *High Level Events*

- **Conversation with Herman Van Rompuy (5 February 2024):**



As part of our European Elections Debate Series, the Alumni Association had the privilege of hosting Herman Van Rompuy, former President of the European Council, in a dynamic conversation with our community. The session offered an in-depth reflection on Europe's future, governance challenges, and Belgium's role in the EU. Moderated by Teona Lavrelashvili, President of the Alumni Association, this event deepened alumni engagement in European debates and helped bridge institutional insights with grassroots perspectives. Around 100 Alumni participated to this event.







- **The Role of Youth in the Future of Europe (6 May 2024):** The Alumni Association took part in a high-level event organised by the Permanent Delegation of Türkiye to the EU, focusing on the role of youth in shaping Europe's future. The conference gathered high-profile speakers from the diplomatic corps, as well as representatives from European and Belgian political and academic circles, to exchange perspectives on youth engagement, leadership, and the future of the European project.

- **Event and Reception ahead of EP Elections (29 May 2025):** The Alumni Association, in collaboration with alumnus Ambassador Faruk Kaymakçı of the Permanent Delegation of Türkiye to the EU, hosted a high-level reception ahead of the European Parliament elections. The event featured Executive Vice President Margaritis Schinas, Klaus Welle, and Jaume Duch, who shared insights on the Commission's achievements, electoral implications, and strategic communications. Teona Lavrelashvili, President of the Alumni Association, highlighted recent alumni activities and their role in shaping Europe's future. The evening brought alumni together for reflection, dialogue, and reconnection.










- **High-Level Outlook on the Belgian Presidency of the Council of the EU (24 June 2024):** In conversation with H.E. Ambassador Hendrik Van de Velde, Coordinator for the 2024 Belgian Presidency, the Alumni Association discussed key achievements such as the €50 billion support package for Ukraine and the adoption of the Pact on Migration and Asylum. Ambassador Van de Velde also reflected on managing geopolitical and electoral challenges and shared how *L'Esprit du Collège* has influenced his diplomatic career. The discussion was chaired by Gabriel Papeians de Morchoven, Board Member.




- **Conversation with Didier Reynders (14 November 2024):** The Alumni Association hosted European Commissioner for Justice Didier Reynders as part of the High-Level Dialogue Series. Commissioner Reynders delivered a keynote on the rule of law and democratic legitimacy, highlighting the Rule of Law Toolbox and Annual Rule of Law Reports. The event featured interventions by François-Xavier Bellamy, MEP and Vice-Chair of the EPP Group, and opening remarks by Federica Mogherini, Rector of the College of Europe. Moderated by Teona Lavrelashvili, President of the Alumni Association, the debate emphasised alumni engagement in defending EU values. The event was supported by the Hanns Seidel Foundation.





## SOCIAL AND NETWORKING EVENTS



- **MeetUp at Aloft (22 March 2024):** This informal gathering, which celebrated its tenth anniversary in 2022, offered an opportunity to meet new people or reconnect with fellow alumni. Several members of the Board were present and introduced themselves, as well as the various ongoing projects, to the 65 alumni who had registered for the event.

- **DG MEME & EU Elections Event (9 April 2024):** Hosted Fabio Mauri, Director General of DG MEME, for a discussion on EU elections and communication. Moderated by Board member Alessandro Mattucci, the event attracted 90+ participants and included a lively Q&A session. One of our favorite quotes from that night: "EU Communication is about Millennials instructed by Boomers to convince Generation Z"



- **Book Discussion: *Circle of Stars* (12 September 2024):** The Alumni Association, in collaboration with the **UK Mission to the EU**, hosted a discussion of Professor Dermot Hodson's book *Circle of Stars: A History of the EU and the People Who Made It*. The event explored Europe's integration history and the individuals who shaped it. The conversation was moderated by Giles Goodall, Head of Inter-Institutional Relations and Communication at DG JUST, and offered alumni a unique perspective on Europe's past and present.





- **Halloween Networking Night (29 October 2024)** – The Alumni Association celebrated Halloween with a **festive networking event** bringing together members of the Distinguished Alumni Network.



# 4. ALUMNI REGIONAL GROUPS AND ACTIVITIES

## *Overview Activities 2025*

The Alumni Association maintains **regional groups** to foster networking and engagement at a local level. Contacts with **regional coordinators have been re-established**, and the list of coordinators has been updated.

**Regional Groups**

- Number of groups: 12
- Countries:
- Coordinators: ongoing contact with all coordinators

### Czech Republic

- **Informal discussion with Ms. Vera Jourova, April 2025** – ongoing efforts to maintain alumni-student connections with the Ministry of Education.

### Italy





- ***Selection Process of Italian Students, 14–17 April 2025*** – Italian Regional Group members observed the selection of future students.
- ***"A Night with the Polish Presidency," 3 March 2025*** – Hosted by the Polish Ambassador, including discussions on Polish EU presidency priorities, followed by a concert and traditional Polish dinner.

## Sweden

- ***Reception with Federica Mogherini, 14 October 2025*** – Hosted by the European Commission in Stockholm, the Rector of the College will share her vision for the College of Europe's expansion and provide insights on the EU's role in the current geopolitical landscape, drawing on her experience as High Representative of the European Union for Foreign Affairs and Security Policy.

## *Regional and International Gatherings organised by the Alumni Association*

| City | Date |
|---|---|
| Shanghai, China | 1 June 2025 |
| Stockholm, Sweden | 16 June 2025 |
| Athens, Greece | 22 June 2025 |
| Tirana, Albania | 16 July 2025 |
| Tbilisi, Georgia | 6 August 2025 |
| Strasbourg, France – Discussion on the State of the Union | 10 September 2025 |
| Rome, Italy | 29 October 2025 |
| London, UK | 29 October 2025 |
| London, UK | 9 December 2025 |
| Strasbourg, France | 17 December 2025 |



*1.Gathering in Tirana, Albania*

*2.Gathering in Tbilisi, Georgia*



### *3.Gathering in Strasbourg, France – Discussion on the State of the Union*



## *Overview Activities 2024*

### Austria

- ***Summer Gathering, July 2024*** – Hosted at LGP law firm in Vienna, with a keynote speech by Prof. Dr. Josef Azizi, former Austrian judge at the General Court in Luxembourg.

- ***Winter Reunion, December 2024*** – Held at Café Landtmann, preceded by a meet-up at the Vienna Christmas Market. Nearly 50 alumni attended, representing 25 different promotions. Special greetings were received from Willibald Pahr (Erasmus class of 1953/54), former Austrian Foreign Minister.



## Czech Republic

- ***Christmas Tea, December 2024*** – Hosted at the British Embassy in Prague, providing an informal networking opportunity.

## Italy

- ***Dialogue on the future of Europe hosted by the Spanish Ambassador to Italy, 25 January 2024*** – The Spanish Ambassador to Italy Miguel Fernández-Palacios, hosted a Dialogue on the future of Europe with keynote speeches by the Chairmen of the EU Committees of Senate and Lower Chamber, Senator Giulio Terzi di Sant' Agata and Member of the Parliament Alessandro Giglio Vigna. The discussion was attended by 40 Alumni of the College of Europe and was followed by networking drinks.





- ***Selection process of the 2024-2025 Italian students at the College of Europe, March 2024*** – The members of the Italian Regional Group took part as observers into the selection process of the future students at the College of Europe, organized by the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation and with the participation of Bruges and Natolin selection committees' representatives.

- ***Closed door seminar on EU 2024 elections, 18 April 2024*** – Teresa Coratella, member of the Italian Regional Group, attended a closed-door seminar on EU 2024 elections with the participation of two Members of the European Parliament, Camilla Laureti and Elisabetta De Blasis; Lorenzo Pregliasco, co-Founder of Youtrend; and Francesca Rinaldi, journalist from GR Parlamento. The event was organized by the Association Il Chiostro and was co-chaired by Nicola Tinelli, Ancien from the Natolin Campus.




- ***Award Ceremony, 11 July 2024*** – Organized with the Department of European Affairs of the Italian Prime Minister's Office, celebrating the best Italian students of the Madeline Albright Promotion. Italian Minister Raffaele Fitto presented the awards.

- ***Christmas Networking, 4 December 2024*** – Hosted by the Belgian Ambassador in Rome, with a discussion on the results of the Belgian EU Presidency, followed by networking drinks.



## United Kingdom

- ***EU Delegation Events in London, 7 May 2024*** – Alumni participated in a panel discussion on the 20th anniversary of the "big bang" enlargement and the prospects for future European enlargement**.**

- ***Alumni-Led Event, April 2024*** – The Austrian Lawyers Network, together with Austrian Ambassador Bernd Wrabetz**,** hosted a discussion on "Competition Law and Democracy: Current Challenges**"**, open to alumni.



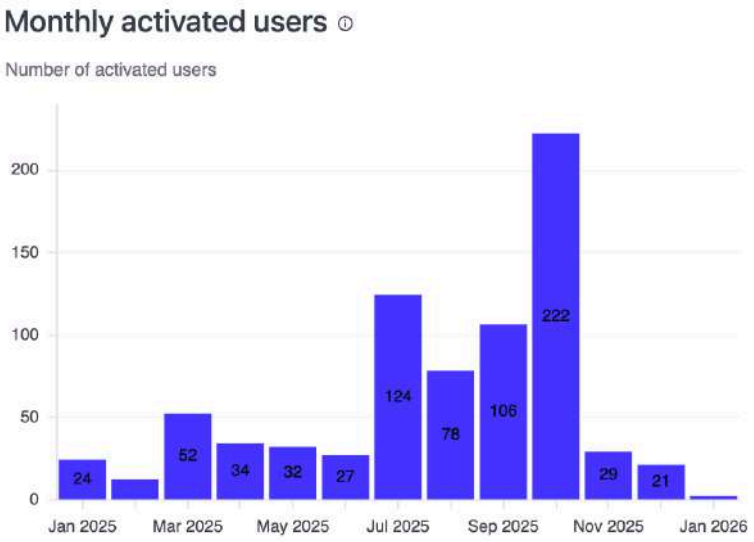



## 5. HIVEBRITE PLATFORM

Hivebrite is a comprehensive **community management platform** that allows the Association to engage alumni effectively. It provides a **centralised digital hub** for communication, collaboration, and networking, enhancing the value of being part of the alumni community.

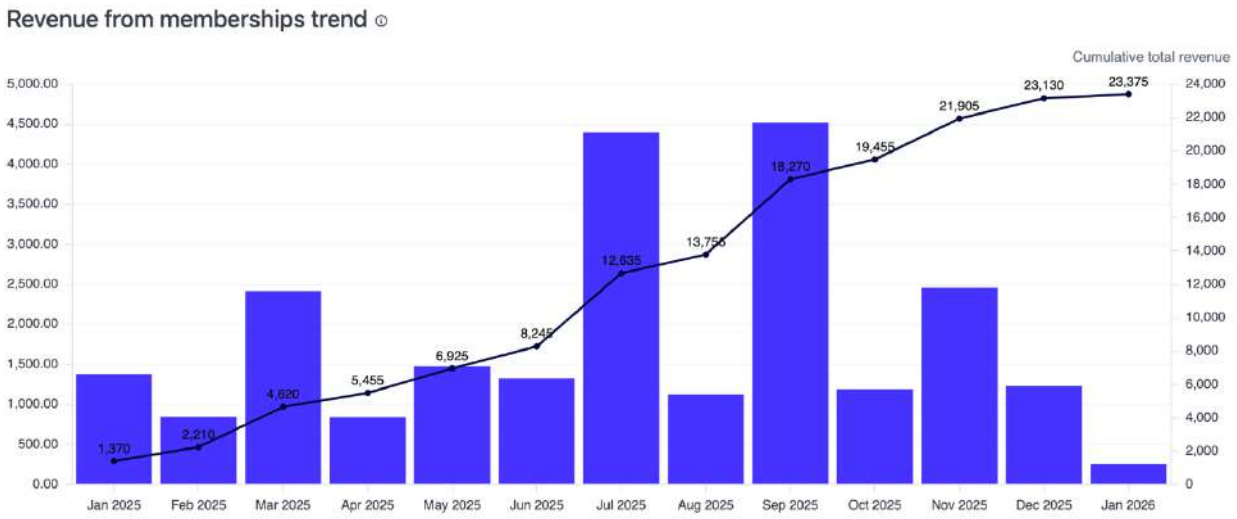
### Key Highlights

- **Network Size:** 18,000 students, with **8,815 actively engaging** on the platform
- **Services and Benefits:**
  - Promotes **networking opportunities** and **high-level events**
  - Offers **exclusive discounts and strategic partnerships**
  - Keeps alumni **connected and informed** about news and opportunities
- **Recent Initiatives:**
  - **February 2025:** Campaign for anniversary dinners increased registrations on Hivebrite
  - **1 July 2025:** Targeted messages on how to **activate and update alumni profiles**
  - Resulted in a **significant increase** in alumni requests to join or update their information
- **Ongoing Efforts:**
  - Ensuring **current profiles** to provide timely updates
  - Creating a **database of alumni in senior positions** to enhance networking and targeted engagement
- **Account Activations (Sep 2024–Sep 2025):** About **500 new users** activated their accounts (see graph below)



## 6. MEMBERSHIP

The membership revenue continued to grow steadily over the year, reaching over **€15,500 by September 2025**, supported by **439 active memberships**. Purchases increased by **66% compared to the previous year** (see graph below), reflecting strong engagement from alumni. This growth coincides with targeted campaigns and flagship initiatives, such as the Mentorship Programme and the EPSO AD5 Competition Training offer, which have not only provided valuable opportunities for professional development but also encouraged alumni to actively invest in their membership. The increase in subscriptions demonstrates the continued relevance of the Association's activities and the value that alumni place on being connected to the wider College network.



## 7. PARTNERSHIPS

The Alumni Association continues to develop and strengthen **strategic partnerships** to provide alumni with enhanced professional and personal opportunities.

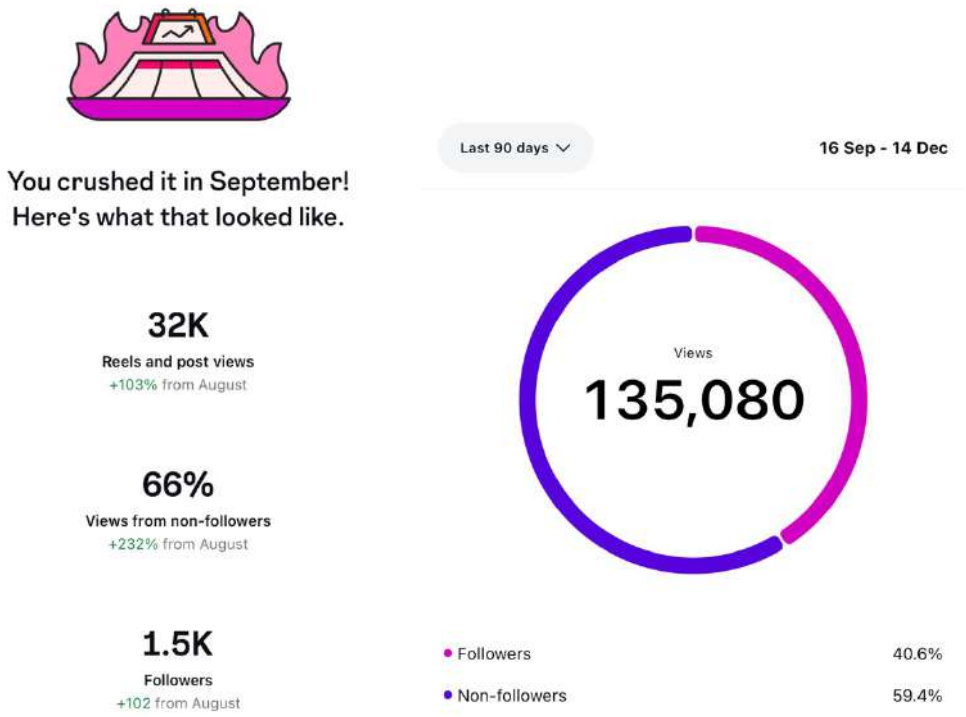
- **UK Mission to the EU:** Collaboration on the 2025/26 Leadership Event Series, building on last year's successful initiative. Alumni will participate in high-level discussions on economic development, innovation, and security, while reinforcing the Association's connections with key EU stakeholders.
- **Aspria:** Offers alumni reduced membership rates and special conditions for existing members, supporting well-being, networking, and access to premium facilities.
- **Alliance Française:** Provides discounted and tailored French courses, covering general, legal, diplomatic, EU affairs, and business French. This initiative enhances professional development and supports personal and cultural growth within the community.
- **EU Training:** The Association has established a partnership with EU Training, which provides alumni with discount codes to access online materials and webinars for EPSO preparation, including support for AD5 competitions. Alumni benefit from practical exam preparation, personal coaching, and tailored workshops, helping them strengthen their skills and succeed in EU career opportunities.
- **What's Up EU:** A weekly newsletter summarising key EU developments. They have offered to draft minutes of gatherings and conferences organised by the Alumni Association, which alumni can access through our channels. Alumni benefit from concise, reliable updates on EU affairs and enhanced engagement with the broader European community.

Overall, these strategic partnerships serve to broaden opportunities for alumni, strengthen our network, and enhance the value of membership in the College of Europe Alumni Association.

## 8. SOCIAL MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

The Alumni Association has continued to expand its presence across Instagram, Facebook, and LinkedIn, increasing engagement and visibility across the network.

- Instagram: The platform is showing **significant growth**, with followers rising from 900 to 1,613 (data below). We have also established a **collaboration with the College of Europe**, who regularly repost our content to promote events, further enhancing our visibility and reach among students and alumni.




- Facebook: Engagement on Facebook remains relatively lower compared to Instagram and LinkedIn. This is largely because **students and younger alumni prefer more visual and interactive platforms** such as Instagram for following updates and events.

- LinkedIn: The Association's presence on LinkedIn is also **growing steadily**, reflecting the platform's importance for professional networking and career-related content. Below, you can find an overview of the **key engagement metrics and follower growth** over the past months.




**Social Media Accounts College of Europe Alumni Association:**

- **Instagram**: https://www.instagram.com/collegeofeuropealumni?igsh=MTVleG51aHg4cG4xbw%3D%3D&utm_source=qr
- **Facebook**: https://www.facebook.com/coleuropealumni/
- **LinkedIn**: https://www.linkedin.com/company/coleuropealumni
- **Flickr**: https://www.flickr.com/photos/132988921@N02/

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